PEER REVIEW HISTORY

BMJ Open publishes all reviews undertaken for accepted manuscripts. Reviewers are asked to complete a checklist review form (**http://bmjopen.bmj.com/site/about/resources/checklist.pdf**) and are provided with free text boxes to elaborate on their assessment. These free text comments are reproduced below.

ARTICLE DETAILS

TITLE (PROVISIONAL)	Effectiveness of nonpharmacological interventions for reducing postpartum fatigue: A systematic review protocol
AUTHORS	Qian, Jialu; Sun, Shiwen; Liu, Lu; Yu, Xiaoyan

VERSION 1 – REVIEW

REVIEWER	Aksu, Sevde Balikesir Universitesi
REVIEW RETURNED	17-May-2021

GENERAL COMMENTS	Dear researcher, first of all, I congratulate you for your systematic review on a subject that is not out of date ... I will offer a few suggestions ... First, Let's review the reference number of the 4th line on page 6. Then, Why did you not include aromatherapy and refloxology applications for postpartum fatigue in the study?

REVIEWER	Biana, Camilla Universidade Federal de Pelotas
REVIEW RETURNED	17-May-2021

GENERAL COMMENTS	The only inclusion that i suggest is the definition of postpartum period and when will be considerable postpartum. For example: will be include articles that available postpartum fatigue after 1 year of labour?

REVIEWER	Liu, Na The Second Affiliated Hospital of Chongqing Medical University
REVIEW RETURNED	25-Aug-2021

GENERAL COMMENTS	1. This research question is appropriate, but more evidence and research about the research topic is needed in the Introduction to illustrate the significance of the research ; 2. Line 27 : Please elaborate on the current research status of postpartum fatigue, enumerate more evidence, and why nonpharmacological interventions is studied rather than other interventions, so as to explain the reasons and significance of this study.

VERSION 1 – AUTHOR RESPONSE

Response to Reviewer #1:
Dear researcher, first of all, I congratulate you for your systematic review on a subject that is not out of date ...
I will offer a few suggestions ...
First, Let's review the reference number of the 4th line on page 6.
Then, Why did you not include aromatherapy and refloxology applications for postpartum fatigue in the study?
Reply:
We appreciate the positive feedback from the reviewer. We would like to thank the reviewer for thorough reading of this manuscript.

Thank you for the reviewer's careful reviewing. For the reference number, actually, the sentence cited 3 relevant studies. We have revised the reference format to avoid ambiguity. The text now reads:

" It may increase the risk of depression, anxiety and sleep problems4,6,13,14 ".

Thank you for the reviewer's helpful suggestion. In the section of eligibility criteria for interventions, we just gave some examples of potential interventions that we may include. As suggested, we have added aromatherapy and refloxology in the eligibility criteria.

Response to Reviewer #2:
The only inclusion that i suggest is the definition of postpartum period and when will be considerable postpartum. For example: will be include articles that available postpartum fatigue after 1 year of labour?
Reply:
Thank you for this valuable comment. In our study, we defined postpartum as 0 to 78 weeks after giving birth. The duration has also been described in the inclusion criteria. The reason for the definition of this duration has been added in the last paragraph of Introduction. The text now reads:

"Considering postpartum fatigue duration is in direct proportion to the severity of related health effects, it ranges from the first postpartum weeks to several months24. A previous systematic review8 indicated that the longest follow-up time of postpartum fatigue is 78 weeks after delivery. Therefore, we define postpartum as 0 to 78 weeks after giving birth in our study."

Response to Reviewer #3:
Comment 1:
This research question is appropriate, but more evidence and research about the research topic is needed in the Introduction to illustrate the significance of the research ;
Reply:
We appreciate the positive feedback from the reviewer. We would like to thank the reviewer for the thoughtful comments and constructive suggestions, which help to improve the quality of this manuscript.

As suggested, we have added more references in terms of characteristics of postpartum fatigue and the persistent adverse influences of postpartum fatigue on mothers' health as well as the development of offspring, so as to emphasize the significance of our study. Please see in the section of Introduction.

Comment 2:

Line 27：Please elaborate on the current research status of postpartum fatigue, enumerate more evidence, and why nonpharmacological interventions is studied rather than other interventions, so as to explain the reasons and significance of this study.
Reply:
Thank you for the reviewers' valuable comment. We have enumerated more evidence and given details of interventions to elaborate on the current research status of postpartum fatigue. Please see in the Introduction.

In regard to the reason for focusing on nonpharmacological interventions, we have added an explaination in the Introduction. The text now reads:
"Mothers have to breastfeed their babies in postpartum period. Comparing with pharmacological interventions, nonpharmacological interventions are safer for both mothers and babies. Nonpharmacological interventions are also more convenient to be applied in practice. Therefore, this review will focus on nonpharmacological interventions for reducing postpartum fatigue. "

VERSION 2 – REVIEW

REVIEWER	Liu, Na The Second Affiliated Hospital of Chongqing Medical University
REVIEW RETURNED	14-Sep-2021

GENERAL COMMENTS	The purpose of this study is clearly stated in this paper. It is recommended that the definition of the postpartum fatigue duration in the Line24, Page 6 be placed in the Interventions of Methods (Line42, Page 8).